46. It is worth noting that mid-twentieth-century archaeological surveys of Ahangaran and its vicinity yielded unglazed painted ceramics initially dated to "Kushano-Sasanian" occupation, which has usually meant *c.* 500 CE. Cf. Baker and Allchin 1991: 107–109 and fig. 4.29 (reproduced from Leshnik 1968); Ball 2019: No. 15; Ball, Bordeaux et al. 2019: 391. This would have impacted the significance of the site for our purposes, rendering it a pre-existing and thus *inherited* site for the pre-imperial Shansabanis. However, Franke's (2016d: 235–236) recent analysis of comparable unglazed painted pottery in the Herat Museum has resulted in assigning that entire collection to the tenth–thirteenth centuries, concurrent with the glazed and other types. The Herat examples that most closely parallel the Ahangaran finds include Cat. Nos. PP120–PP127.
47. Cf. A. A. Kohzad 1954a: 29, 31; Wannell 2002: 236–237.
48. Herberg 1982: 80; (cf. also Thomas 2018: 116).
49. Both sites are among the many significant but scantily documented locales throughout central and southern Ghur. Qala'-yi Chahar Baradar was also known as Pa'in Mazar, and Muna Ala as Mullah Ala and Mala Alau: cf. esp. Ball 2002: 33–35; Ball 2008: 151–152 for a general description of the Ana Valley, with Muna Ala in its western reaches; also Ball 2019: No. 742. For Qala'-yi Chahar Baradar, see Ball 2019: No. 787, and map 20.
50. Juzjani vol. I, 1963: 328, 331 (trans. vol. I, 1881: 318, 331). Mentioned in M. N. Kohzad 1959; and published with analysis by Thomas et al. 2014 (also listed in Ball 2019: No. 974). Thomas et al. (2014: 139) proposed that the "lost" *minar* of Qala'-yi Zarmurgh (discussed *infra* in main text) was most comparable "geographically, stylistically, and perhaps chronologically … [with] the mud-brick [*sic*] decoration on the Hephthalite and early Islamic fortresses of Ghur," indirectly suggesting a pre-Islamic date for the latter. As detailed below, however, the decorative programs of these two corpora of structures actually ensue from discrete architectural cultures.
51. For the Daulatabad *minar*, see Sourdel-Thomine 1953: 122–129; Ball and Fischer 2019: 484–487. For the Qasimabad *minar*, see Tate [1910] 1977: 22 and facing, 270 and facing; and esp. O'Kane (1984: 97), who provided a span of 1125–1150 CE for the *minar*'s construction, based on stylistic and epigraphic comparison with more securely dated Saljuq towers, including the one at Daulatabad. The dissemination of *minar*s across Afghanistan adds further weight to Najimi's (2015: n. 46; cf. also Chapter 1) observations regarding the mobility of specialized artisans, and their availability for patronage/employment at varying locales. See also *infra* in main text.
52. Many Saljuq *minar*s, the two Ghaznavid examples, and, of course, the later *minar* of Jam-Firuzkuh (AH 570/1174–75 CE) combined baked brick and stucco in their epigraphic programs: while the Kufic or decorated (floriated) Kufic tended to be executed in brick, the letters seem at times to be placed against highly ornate, floral-arabesque backgrounds fashioned of stucco. The *naskh* and other more curvilinear calligraphic styles were also executed in the more pliant stucco. See Sourdel-Thomine 1953; Pinder-Wilson 2001; cf. also Appendix.
53. A locality close to our area of study would be the Zoroastrian pilgrimage site